

Chapter 144_2 - Flying Flower Sect

Ning Fuyi left a message for Chu Qingqiu through a fairy attendant, then followed Liu Wenzhu toward Flying Flower Sect. Flying Flower Sect was the closest sect to Cloud Ascension Mountain Gate, so after flying on swords for just half a day, they could see Flying Flower Sect's most eye-catching golden pillar gate tower.

The gate tower looked as if it was adorned with flowing gold under the setting sun, gleaming brilliantly. Behind the gate tower were layered black-gold buildings, with iron-armored beasts standing guard on every roof edge, creaking as they turned their heads.

Compared to jade towers and magnificent palaces, this had an even more vigorous and imposing aura.

The two had just landed beneath the gate tower when they heard rustling sounds. The ground beneath their feet actually cracked into several pieces like a chessboard, then began flipping and changing.

Liu Wenzhu exclaimed in amazement and grabbed Ning Fuyi's arm. The ground beneath their feet suddenly began sliding forward along the chessboard pattern on its own. This scene was so peculiar that even Ning Fuyi couldn't help but praise it.

Truly worthy of Flying Flower Sect, famous throughout the world for its mechanism arts.

After sliding between those black-gold buildings, the ground beneath their feet returned to normal. Ning Fuyi looked up and saw that the buildings here were much taller than those in other places, making her feel as if she were standing in a deep mountain forest, except the trees had been replaced by towering pavilions.

"Are you two here to see the Sect Master?" a Flying Flower Sect disciple asked with a bow.

"Yes, I am Liu Wenzhu, and this is Ning Fuyi. Please trouble yourself to announce us to Sect Master Hua," Liu Wenzhu spoke.

"Certainly. Please follow me and wait for a moment while I go report to the Sect Master." The disciple politely turned and led the two of them into a black-gold building.

Inside was also vastly different from ordinary places. The floor was bright as oil, and mechanical birds created through mechanism arts occasionally flew overhead. The disciple served them two cups of hot tea, then departed.

Liu Wenzhu reached out to touch the birds overhead, admiringly saying: "I'd always known Flying Flower Sect's mechanism arts were formidable, but I never knew they were this miraculous. These copper birds are so much more lifelike than the wooden message birds of our Cloud Ascension Mountain Gate."

"After all, it's a sect that made its fortune through mechanism arts, so naturally it's different," Ning Fuyi said, reaching out to catch a bird to study it, accidentally pulling off its tail.

She was at a loss for a moment with both hands, then inserted it back exactly as it was, pretending nothing had happened as she released the bird back to the wild.

The two watched for a long time until the tea on the table had gone cold, yet still no sign of Hua Hong appeared. Finally, even Liu Wenzhu lost patience and stood at the door looking around.

"Yiyi, is this Sect Master Hua unwilling to see us?" Liu Wenzhu asked.

"Half a shichen¹ has passed - even if this Hua Hong were on his deathbed, he should have been carried here by now," Ning Fuyi said calmly, then stood up and walked toward Liu Wenzhu. "I originally thought this person was merely slippery and cunning, but never imagined he'd also be as timid as a mouse."

"Rather than waiting around like this, we might as well raid his lair - then he'll have no choice but to show himself."

Liu Wenzhu was about to stop Ning Fuyi when she suddenly looked down and saw something that made her face turn deathly pale as she backed away repeatedly. Just as she was about to scream, Ning Fuyi blocked her path and restrained the approaching object.

"Don't be afraid, it's not a real snake." Ning Fuyi rolled up her sleeves and bent down to pick up the lifelike wooden snake.

The wooden snake's body writhed for a moment, then finally spit out a paper ball. Ning Fuyi unfolded the paper ball, and a line of blood-red characters came into view.

"East corridor, thirteen chi² west, come save me quickly!"

Footnotes:

1. **Shichen (时辰)** - A traditional Chinese time unit equal to two hours
2. **Chi (尺)** - A traditional Chinese unit of length, approximately equivalent to one foot or 0.33 meters